2.12 Electrolyte Imbalances

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Complains of palpitations and weak muscles **Objective** • Serum K^+ 2.9 mmol/L (or above 5.5 mmol/L) • Irregular pulse • ECG changes	**ACTUAL** **Decreased cardiac output** related to altered heart rhythm secondary to potassium imbalance as evidenced by irregular pulse and ECG changes.	Within 24 hours the rhythm is regular and serum K^+ is 3.5–5.0 mmol/L.	• Continuous ECG monitoring, as ordered. • Give potassium replacement, or treatment to lower it, as prescribed. • Potassium is never given as an IV push; always use an infusion pump. • Recheck serum K^+ as ordered.	Rhythm and K^+ back to normal: **goal met**.
Subjective • Family says she has become confused **Objective** • Serum Na^+ 124 mmol/L • Does not know the time or place	**ACTUAL** **Acute confusion** related to sodium imbalance as evidenced by disorientation and abnormal serum sodium.	Oriented to time, place and person as the sodium comes back to normal.	• Check level of consciousness and orientation every 4 hours. • Correct the sodium slowly, as prescribed. • Restrict fluids if ordered. • Reorient her and keep the surroundings calm.	Oriented: **goal met**. Seizures or worse confusion must be reported.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Muscle weakness • Confusion • On diuretics	**RISK** **Risk for adult falls** as evidenced by risk factors: muscle weakness, confusion and medications.	No falls.	• Put fall precautions in place. • Help her when she moves. • Keep the call bell where she can reach it.	No falls: **goal met**.